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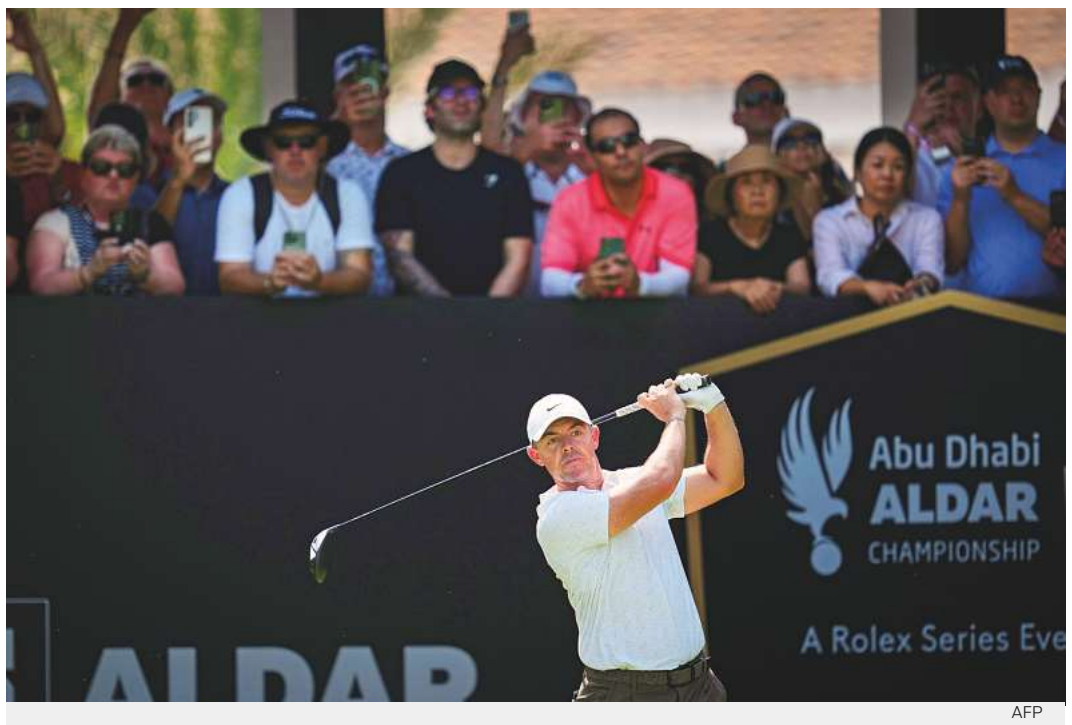
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GULF NEWS

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LIVE UPDATES





AFP

MCILROY TEES OFF IN ABU DHABI

■ Rory McIlroy of Northern Ireland hits off the first tee during the first round of the Abu Dhabi Aldar Championship yesterday. The world No 2 posted a 2-under 70 to lie tied-33rd in a group of 11 golfers, after he was handed a two-shot penalty, with officials ruling he improved his lie on a hole where he made double-bogey. The penalty left him eight shots off the lead, held by Italy's Francesco Laporta who carded a bogey-free round of 62. **SEE ALSO P15**

US midterms shock drives up world stocks

US STOCKS UP FOR SECOND DAY; CHIP STOCKS PULL JAPAN, S KOREA LOWER

DUBAI

BY STACY PEREIRA
Business Reporter

Stock markets in much of the world rose again yesterday after the US midterm elections. Shares in Europe, Britain, mainland China and Pakistan climbed for a second day after Wall Street rallied, while India and Hong Kong extended longer winning streaks. Falling chip stocks wiped out early gains in a measure of global shares.

Shares in major US companies jumped 3.03 per cent on Wednesday after Republicans lost control of Congress. The broader US market rose 1.6 per cent and a technology-heavy group of stocks gained 1.44 per cent. European and British shares rose again yesterday after both gained 1.8 per cent on Wednesday.

Indian shares closed 2.6 per cent higher yesterday, their sixth straight gain. Hong Kong rose 3.7 per cent, its fifth daily gain in a row. Pakistani shares rose 1.96 per cent, bringing their two-day gain to about 4.4 per cent. Mainland Chinese shares edged higher after climbing 2.16 per cent on Wednesday.

Chip stocks fall, oil rebounds

South Korean shares fell 5.3 per cent as Samsung Electronics dropped 7.6 per cent and memory chipmaker SK Hynix lost 9.4 per cent. In Japan, shares fell 1.8 per cent as Tokyo Electron, which makes equipment used to produce chips, dropped 9.5 per cent.

Charu Chanana, Chief Investment Strategist at Saxo Bank, said investors are already asking whether the money companies pour into AI will pay off. She said closer scrutiny of data centres, power costs and investment incentives could steer investors towards companies that generate cash and can show how their spending will pay off.

Brent crude rose about 2.7 per cent to $97.15 a barrel after falling 8.7 per cent on Wednesday. Traders weighed whether a Democratic-led Congress could press the US administration to scale back the war with Iran. US crude rose to $89.69 a barrel, while Abu Dhabi's Murban fell to $95.89. Gold climbed to $4,117.84 an ounce, up about 5 per cent over two days.

SEE ALSO P6, 10

DH1 TRILLION

Dubai's stock market value climbed back above Dh1 trillion on Wednesday, from Dh967.22 billion a day earlier. Shares rose 3.95 per cent, their biggest daily gain in nearly seven months, before ending yesterday broadly flat. Abu Dhabi shares rose nearly a per cent yesterday. The market had given up its early gains to finish flat on Wednesday. **—S. P.**

Google to turn off AI for students

New controls to be rolled out worldwide, beginning in the US

SAN FRANCISCO

Google has said it will switch off its AI tools for schoolchildren by default, after drawing criticism for pushing artificial intelligence features to students while schools are still debating how the technology should be used in classrooms.

The search engine juggernaut dominates technology in American schools. Its education apps, including Gmail, Docs and the Classroom platform, are used in classrooms across the country, and its low-cost Chromebook laptops are the devices US schools most often issue to students.

More control

Under the changes Google announced in a blog post on Tuesday, Gemini, Gemini Notebook, Gemini in Classroom and Search will be turned off for K-12 student accounts until school administrators switch them on.

Google told AFP the new controls would be rolled out worldwide, beginning in the United States, but that it had not yet set a date. The changes also mean schools will not be able to give students Google Search without its AI features.

Chris Phillips, Google's vice president for education, told *The New York Times* that "Search and A.I. are deeply integrated," as AI features are now built into the company's search engine.

If a school bans AI, he said, students "will not have access to search, and they'll see a message from their school that indicates it's not available."

More than 150 million students worldwide use Google Classroom. — *AFP*

IN FOCUS

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FRIDAY

From gifting guides to sartorial and jewellery trends, bring the sparkle home this Diwali



ABU DHABI

Residents reveal the best feast spots under Dh500 | P11

